Bridge Business Plan and Financial Model

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Executive summary

Bridge is a proposed two-sided marketplace connecting students who offer skills with people or organizations that post paid tasks. The current Stitch screens show profile creation, task discovery, proposals, applicant decisions, match status, and chat. They do not prove demand, establish a launch segment, or specify how Bridge earns revenue. This plan sets out a validation-first business approach and a financial model structure with inputs to be completed by the founders.

Business concept

Bridge helps students present skills and portfolio evidence, discover project work, and apply. Task owners describe work, set skills/budget/deadline, compare applicants, and communicate after selecting a candidate. Bridge's initial business challenge is marketplace liquidity: attracting enough relevant tasks and applicants in a focused launch segment.

Customer hypotheses to validate

Side	Initial hypothesis	Evidence needed
Student supply	Students want a portfolio-led way to find short, skill-relevant paid project work.	Interviews, willingness to apply, profile completion, repeat usage.
Task-owner demand	Small organizations, teams, or individuals need accessible project help and can assess student portfolios.	Interviews, task-posting intent, quality expectations, repeat task demand.
Bridge value	Structured profiles, skill tags, proposals, and a visible decision process reduce search and coordination effort.	Pilot comparison of time-to-first-qualified-applicant and owner satisfaction.

These are hypotheses, not established facts. Select one launch segment before building acquisition campaigns.

Value proposition and positioning

Draft positioning: Bridge helps students turn demonstrable skills into project opportunities and gives task owners a structured way to find and evaluate emerging talent. The initial segment and proof points remain to be chosen.

Potential differentiators to test: student-focused profiles; portfolio evidence attached to applications; task requirements expressed as skills; clear application states; and communication tied to accepted work.

Operating model options

1. **Free pilot:** minimize payment friction while validating matching and repeat usage. Revenue is deferred; pilot costs must be funded.
2. **Task-owner fee:** charge for posting, shortlisting, or successful hires. The triggering event and willingness to pay require interviews.
3. **Transaction fee:** charge on completed paid work. This depends on a payment flow, reconciliation, refunds, and payout operations, none of which are designed in the prototype.

Do not choose a model until customer interviews and a small pilot compare willingness to pay and operational burden.

Go-to-market starting point

Choose one geographic/community or skill-category wedge where both student supply and task-owner demand can be reached directly. Recruit a small, curated cohort on both sides, manually observe the first task/application cycle, and track reasons for drop-off. Expand only after repeat demand and satisfactory applicant quality are demonstrated. See the separate Go-to-Market Plan for experiments and channel detail.

Business risks

Risk	Early response
Not enough demand or supply	Launch in a narrow segment; measure activity on both sides weekly.
Low-quality or vague tasks	Use a posting checklist and review early listings manually.
Applicants receive no response	Track response time; set and communicate an owner response expectation.
Financial metrics imply payment handling that does not exist	Keep payment claims out of the launch promise until funds flow is defined.
Weak trust or unsafe interaction	Establish reporting, moderation, and escalation ownership before opening access broadly.

Financial model structure

Do not insert unsupported values. Populate the model with observed or quoted inputs and mark each as actual, estimate, or assumption.

Inputs

Input	Symbol	Source to use
Monthly active task owners	O	Pilot cohort and funnel data
Tasks posted per active owner per month	T	Pilot behavior
Share of tasks that receive at least one qualified application	Q	Application and owner feedback data
Successful hires per published task	H	Accepted applications and confirmed outcomes
Average task value (if known)	V	Owner-provided budget and completed work data
Platform fee rate or fixed fee (if selected)	F	Pricing experiments and model decision
Monthly operating costs	C	Vendor quotes, staffing plan, and actual invoices
Acquisition cost per activated owner/student	CAC	Channel spend divided by activated users

Core calculations

- Published tasks = active task owners × tasks per owner.
- Tasks with qualified applicants = published tasks × qualified-application rate.
- Completed hires = published tasks × successful-hire rate.
- Gross transaction value (only if tracked) = completed hires × average task value.
- Revenue under a transaction-fee model = gross transaction value × fee rate.
- Contribution before fixed costs = revenue − payment/provider costs − variable support/operations costs.
- Monthly operating result = contribution − fixed operating costs.
- Runway (months) = available cash ÷ average monthly net burn, when burn is positive.

These are model formulas, not forecasts. Avoid using budget displayed on a task as proof that a transaction completed.

Scenarios

Build conservative, base, and upside scenarios by varying measured activation, repeat posting, qualified application rate, successful hire rate, fee adoption, and cost assumptions. Show which values are observed versus hypothetical. Include a zero-revenue pilot case.

Milestones and decision gates

1. **Problem validation:** confirm a specific segment and repeated pain on both sides.
2. **Concierge pilot:** manually seed and review tasks; observe profile-to-application and decision behavior.
3. **Product pilot:** use the core flows and measure activation, quality, response, and repeat intent.
4. **Model decision:** evaluate pricing tests and operational cost after transaction behavior is observed.
5. **Scale decision:** expand only after repeat demand, quality, and support capacity are proven.

Before committing spend or expansion, complete the launch segment, market, pricing/payment scope, funding, operating capacity, and decision thresholds. This plan is based on the Bridge Stitch screens and related PRD/BRD; market demand, prices, and costs are unvalidated.